

I said it in the wedding chapter, and I'll say it again: Flowers are a stunning waste of money, not to mention bad for the planet. It's never lost on me that most fresh-cut flowers are flown by plane from South America, only to end up in the ground a few hours later. If you must have flowers, buy wholesale flowers and have some friends arrange them. Believe me, your friends will be glad to help out during your time of need. Alternatively, skip the flowers and donate that money to a worthy cause. Most funeral homes have decorative urns with artificial flowers that fill out a room nicely.

10 Crucial Financial Questions You Must Ask About Late-in-Life Care

As with funerals, you must have those frank and open discussions about long-term care before you need it. But that begins with honest talk about current financial situations and future needs. So pour the coffee, pull out the financial statements, and put these questions on the table.

- 1. How much money do you have, exactly?** Sometimes parents don't like to tell their children how much money they have. But if your children are your benefactors and/or your executors, they need that information. As long as you're cognizant that the money is still under your control and you can hire a lawyer to ensure it stays that way, tell them everything. In order to make sound decisions about late-in-life care, a realistic snapshot can be achieved only if all the numbers are on the table. Make sure you know where all the files and important papers are located. Remember, this is your money's last real purpose on this planet.
- 2. Do you want to be resuscitated?** This is a really important question, and I hate to put a monetary value on such an ethical conundrum, but you must consider that, in the event of a stroke or heart attack or other major life-and-death event, medical science can do a lot to sustain you. But you may suffer brain